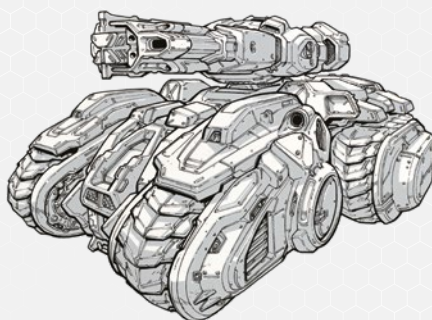


STARCRRAFT®

TABLETOP MINIATURES GAME

[ORGANISED PLAY GUIDE] VERSION 1.0

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ARCHON
STUDIO



TABLETOP BATTLES

ABOUT THIS PACK

This is a guide to running a StarCraft: TMG event, whether that's eight friends in the back of a game shop or a hundred players over a weekend. It covers what you need to decide before you announce, how to run the day itself, and how to score it when the games are done.

Not every event needs all of it. A Community event and a Competitive event ask different things of you, and we've marked throughout where the two part ways.

It's a starting point, not a straitjacket. You are free to add to it, cut from it or change it to suit the event you want to run. We only ask that you publish any changes before registration closes. A change announced on the morning of the event is a surprise, not a change.

Official Archon Studio tournaments are run to this document as written. If you want your event to feel like ours, this is what ours look like.

ROLES AND REQUIREMENTS

The Tournament Organiser

You're the person who makes the event happen. That covers:

- The venue, the tables and the terrain
- The event listing: format, round count, rules cut-off date, roster deadline, layouts in use, software platform and a contact for conduct reports
- Collecting rosters and getting them in front of the players
- Pairings, results and final standings
- The round clock and the milestone calls
- Prizes
- Backing up your Head Judge, and the final decision on any penalty that stands for the rest of the event

Wherever these rules leave a decision open, it's yours to make. Publish what you've decided before registration closes.

Can the Tournament Organiser Play?

	COMMUNITY EVENT	COMPETITIVE EVENT
HJ competes?	Yes	No
Best practice	Hands final say on penalties to the Head Judge	Non-playing for the whole event

At a **Competitive event**, you don't compete. You hold the final word on penalties that run to the end of the event, and nobody should be able to ask whether a call went your way because it was your call.

At a **Community event**, play by all means. The final decision on penalties then passes to your Head Judge for the whole event, not only for the rounds you're in.

The Head Judge

Your Head Judge answers questions and settles disputes once play begins. The job is to keep games moving rather than to police the room. They handle:

- Major rules disagreements players can't resolve themselves
- Slow play, clock disputes and anything else time-related

- Completing a draft that has overrun
- Penalties for illegal rosters and for conduct breaches

A Head Judge's decisions are final for the duration of the event.

A player who thinks a ruling was wrong can raise it with you afterwards, but nothing gets reversed mid-game. That covers rulings at the table. A penalty that stands for the rest of the event is settled together with you.

Can the Head Judge Play?

	COMMUNITY EVENT	COMPETITIVE EVENT
HJ competes?	Yes	No
Best practice	Steps into the pairing when attendance is odd	Non-playing for the whole event

At a **Competitive event**, a judge chasing a trophy can't be seen to be impartial, however impartial they actually are.

At a **Community event**, your Head Judge playing is useful rather than a compromise. Ideally they play in the rounds where your attendance is odd, stepping in as the extra body so that no player has to sit out.

A Head Judge who plays does so as a spare player. They are not classified, they aren't eligible for placings or prizes, and **their results don't go into anyone's Strength of Schedule or oTP pool.**

At larger events, appoint Floor Judges alongside your Head Judge. If only one judge is present, they act as Head Judge and Floor Judge in one person.

Floor Judges

Floor Judges are your judges on the ground, the people players flag down mid-game without leaving the table. They handle:

- Rules disagreements players can't resolve themselves
- Terrain and Mission Marker checking
- Range and Line of Sight checks
- Helping players submit their results

A Floor Judge has full jurisdiction over rules decisions. They don't need to check with anyone before ruling, and their call stands. The Head Judge is escalated to only for the genuinely difficult cases: a contested interaction nobody can find an answer for, a suspected conduct breach, a penalty.

A player who disagrees with a Floor Judge's ruling may ask for it to go to the Head Judge, but must do so before play continues. The Floor Judge's ruling applies in the meantime, and the Head Judge's answer ends the matter.

What Players Need to Bring

Put this list in your event materials. Players who turn up short of any of it will be borrowing from their opponent all weekend, and that costs everybody time.

- Their army
- Dice
- A measuring tool
- Their most up-to-date cards, including draft cards for each roster they've submitted
- A copy of each roster to show an opponent.
We recommend bringing them printed

A printed roster can be handed across the table, left face-up beside the battlefield and read at a glance. A phone can't do any of that while it's also running a clock or a score tracker. If a player is relying on a phone or tablet, keeping it charged is on them, and you should let players know in advance whether power outlets are available.

Models

Official StarCraft: TMG models only. Third-party sculpts, recasts and substitutes aren't permitted at events run under these rules.

Bases may be modelled, and we'd encourage it, since basing is part of the hobby. What matters is that a base keeps the correct size and shape for the model standing on it. Movement, ranges and Line of Sight are all measured off the base, so a base that's grown in the modelling process changes how the model plays.

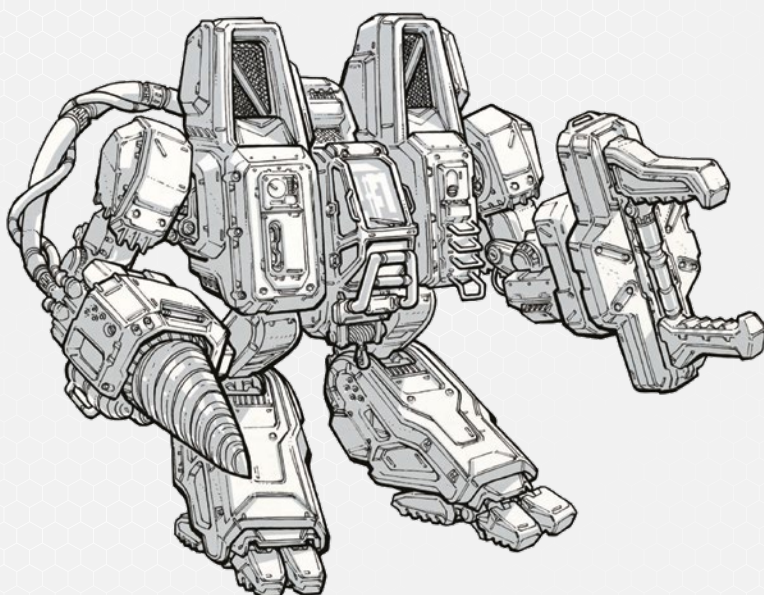
Painting isn't required. Assembled models are enough to compete, and a player is at no disadvantage in the standings for bringing bare plastic.

What You See Is What You Get

	COMMUNITY EVENT	COMPETITIVE EVENT
WYSIWYG requirement	Your call as TO	Required for Specialist models
Everything else	Your call as TO	Clearly identified by the players before the game begins

At a **Community event**, set whatever standard suits your crowd, and say what it is in your event listing.

At a **Competitive event**, any model with the **Specialist** rule must be WYSIWYG. An opponent should be able to look across the table and see which model carries it, without asking. For the rest of the army, players don't need modelled loadouts, **but they must clearly establish what every model is before the game begins.**



EVENT SIZE AND FORMAT

Not every event is trying to do the same thing. Some are there to bring a local scene together; some are there to find a champion. We describe two kinds, and the difference decides your engagement scale, your round count and how tightly you hold to the rest of this pack.

	COMMUNITY EVENT	COMPETITIVE EVENT
Purpose	Bringing players together, welcoming newcomers	Playing at the top of your game, against opponents doing the same
Engagement Scale	Skirmish or Standard	Standard
Length	One day	One or two days
These rules	Adapt freely	Follow as written

Community Events

Community events run over a single day, and you've got two ways to run one. Pick the scale first, because everything else follows from it.

Skirmish gives you shorter games. You fit more rounds into the day, you can take a bigger field, and newer players get through two or three games instead of grinding out one. It's the easier event to run and the easier one to turn up to.

Standard is the full-size game, the same scale competitive events use. You'll fit fewer rounds into a day, but it's what your players will meet if they ever step up to a Competitive event, so it's a good way to give them a taste of it among friends.

PLAYERS	ON SKIRMISH	ON STANDARD
4-8	2-3 rounds	2-3 rounds
9-16	3 rounds	3 rounds
17-32	4 rounds	3 rounds

Competitive Events

This is the format the game is built around. Standard engagement is where every faction's full toolkit is on the table, where the Mission and Deployment draft carries real weight, and where the balance work behind the game is aimed. If a player wants to know how good they actually are, this is the event that answers the question.

That's also why we're stricter here. A Competitive event is a claim that the result means something, so **run it at Standard engagement scale, and follow this pack as written.** Two events on opposite sides of the world should produce results that can be compared.

PLAYERS	DAYS	SWISS ROUNDS
12-32	1	3
33-128	2	5

A championship format for fields above 128 players will be announced.

Adjusting the Round Count

You can change the number of rounds to suit your event, **as long as you state it clearly before the first round begins.**

If your turnout comes in lower than expected, or drops during round one push you into a lower band of the table, you can reduce the round count. Have your Head Judge announce the change as early as possible, and **no later than the start of round two.** Players plan their day around the schedule, and a round quietly disappearing from it is worse than a longer event.

GAME FORMAT

Army cost:

ENGAGEMENT SCALE	MINERALS	VESPENE GAS
Standard	2000	200
Skirmish	1000	100

Rules version: the most recent official rules, errata and FAQ published as at your **rules cut-off date.** We suggest setting that date **two weeks before the event** and announcing it in your event materials. Anything published after it doesn't apply, even if it goes live during the weekend.

ARMY ROSTERS

What a Roster Is

An Army Roster is the complete, written record of the force a player brings, built to the engagement scale the event is running at. It's the document that gets submitted, checked, published and handed across the table.

A roster must show:

- **The player's name**
- **The faction:** Terran, Protoss or Zerg
- **Every unit in the force**, with its loadout and any upgrades taken
- **The Supply value of each unit**, and the total
- **The Mineral cost of each unit**, and the total
- **The Vespene Gas spent on Tactical Cards**, and the total
- **The 2 Mission Cards and 2 Deployment Cards** submitted with that roster

Anything that affects how the army plays belongs on the roster. If an opponent would need to ask about it, write it down.

Dual List Format

This is the format we recommend. Under Dual List Format:

- Each player may submit **up to two Army Rosters**
- Both rosters must be from the **same faction**
- Each roster brings its own draft cards, so a player submitting two rosters submits two sets
- A player who submits one roster plays it every round

You're free to run **Single List Format instead.** Announce it in your event rules.

Submission and Publication

Players submit their rosters one week before the event, so there's time to check them. That's a week after the rules cut-off, which gives players seven days to react to anything the cut-off caught before they commit to a list.

How far in advance the rosters are then published to the rest of the field is your call. Decide it before you announce the event and state it clearly in your event materials, so players know whether they're preparing blind or against a known field.

You can also set a penalty for late submission, announced in advance.

Open Lists

Every submitted roster is revealed to the opponent before the game begins.

Checking rosters is your responsibility and your Head Judge's, but every participant should report any discrepancy they notice. With every list open to every entrant, players will spot things. If someone believes a roster is illegal, they raise it with you, and you settle it with the roster's owner.

Illegal Rosters

If a roster turns out to be illegal after play has begun:

- If the mistake is small, or both players agree to continue, completed games stand as played
- The Head Judge may adjust the state of the game before play resumes
- The player corrects the roster under judge supervision, making the smallest change that fixes it
- The Head Judge, in consultation with the TO, may apply a penalty proportionate to the advantage gained

TABLES AND TERRAIN

Table Size

Playing area: 36" × 54" (roughly 91 × 137 cm).

On top of that, each player should be given a minimum of 30 cm (12") of clear surface for cards, dice, tokens and clocks, either on the table beyond the playing area or on a side table.

In practice that means a table of around 60" × 54", or a 36" × 54" table plus a side table per player.

Layouts

Tables **must be set up before the event begins**, by you or your judging staff. Players don't build their own.

You can use either the **official Map Layouts** or **community-made layouts.**

If you're using community layouts, **choose them in advance and present them in your event listing**, both which layouts you'll be using and how many. Players should know what they're playing on before they register.

Every table must clearly identify which layout it's set to. A printed copy of the layout at the table edge, or simply its name or number on a card, whatever lets a player check quickly. Players should check the terrain against it before the game begins, and put every piece back where it belongs when they're done.

We recommend setting each table's layout once and leaving it alone for the whole event. Don't reset, rotate or reshuffle terrain between rounds. It keeps a hidden variable out of your standings, and it saves you a great deal of work between rounds. Where your pairing software allows it, try to place each player on a different table in each Swiss round.

Players need to see the terrain before the draft begins. Have tables fully set up before pairings go up, and get players to their table before the round clock starts. The draft is a decision about the shape of the battlefield, and it's hard to make against terrain nobody has looked at. Players should also agree between themselves, before the draft begins, on the Size of each terrain piece and the rules it provides.

Mission Markers and Impassable Terrain

Mission Markers can't be placed on impassable terrain. Where a Marker's coordinates fall on an impassable piece:

- **Move the terrain**, not the marker, to the nearest legal position to its original coordinates
- The player **whose colour isn't associated with that Marker** decides how it moves. **Where more than one position is equally close, that player also chooses the direction**
- For **Neutral Mission Marker 5**, players Roll-Off to decide who moves it

Marker is never moved to accommodate the terrain.

If the players can't agree, a judge places it and that's that.

Custom Terrain and Layouts

We'd encourage you to use our official map layouts and terrain. That said, we know that communities run tournaments on custom terrain for all sorts of reasons: availability, cost, or simply a collection they've built up and are proud of.

If you're going that route, give your players a chance to familiarise themselves with your terrain and layouts before they arrive. Where you can, put everything about them on the event page: which layouts you're using, how many, and what the terrain actually looks like. Nobody should be seeing your table for the first time on the morning of the event.

When you're building a custom layout, we'd suggest keeping these guidelines in mind. Assign every piece to a Size category before the event, and aim for roughly this composition:

PAIRINGS

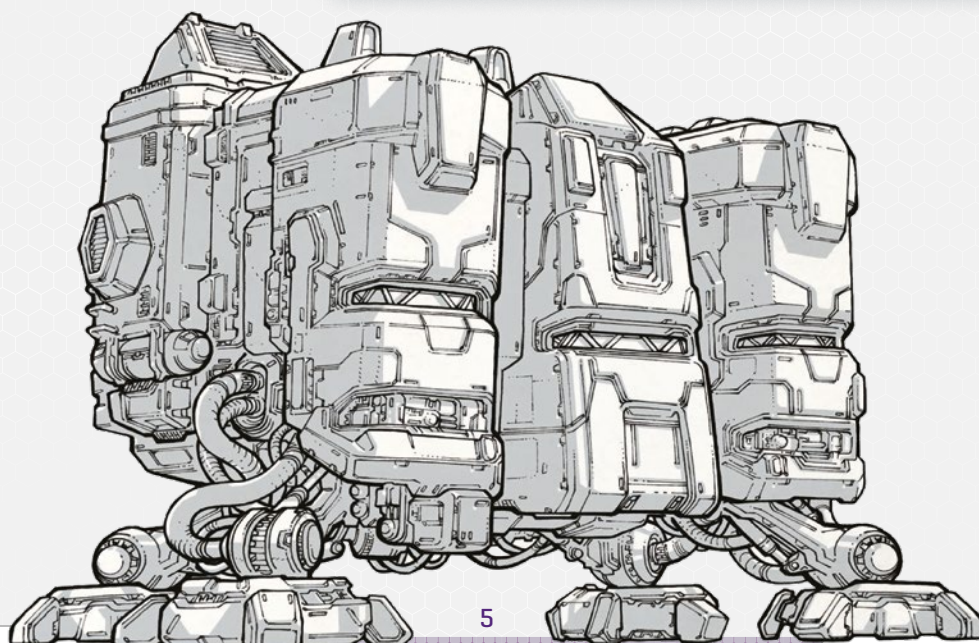
Pair your rounds using the Swiss system.

- Round one is paired randomly, or by a seeding method you've announced in advance
- Later rounds pair players on equal or nearest record
- Avoid repeat pairings wherever the bracket lets you

SIZE	PIECES PER TABLE	EXAMPLES	EFFECT
0	0-2	Scatter terrain	Incidental
1	2-4	Barricades, low walls, crates	Cover for infantry. Doesn't block Line of Sight for models larger than Size 1
2	6-8	Ruins, bunkers, wrecked vehicles	Blocks Line of Sight for most standard Units. Creates fire lanes and chokepoints
3+	1-2	Large structures, elevated platforms	Creates High Ground. Blocks Line of Sight for almost everything
Grass (Size 2 special)	4-6	Woods, tall growth	Doesn't block movement. Gives Line of Sight cover across open ground

Size 2 pieces are the backbone of a table. A collection heavy on crates and low walls will look full and play flat.

Try to match the footprint of the official pieces you're standing in for. A Size 2 piece with twice the official footprint changes the table even when its category is right.



Byes

With an odd number of players, one player each round receives a **bye**.

- Give it to someone who hasn't had one yet, from the lowest-scoring bracket
- A bye is scored as 3 MP and 4 TP (see **Games That Don't End Normally**)
- Nobody gets a second bye while an eligible player has had none
- Allocate byes in early rounds wherever the bracket allows

At a Community event, your Head Judge stepping into the pairing is a better answer than a bye.

Drops

- A player withdrawing must tell you before you generate pairings for the next round
- Their completed results stand (see **Which Games Count**)
- A player who drops can't re-enter
- A player who doesn't appear without notice is dropped, and their opponent is scored as for a bye

Conceding a Game

A player may concede at any point. The game is then scored as an **Annihilation** for their opponent (see **Games That Don't End Normally**), and it counts toward both opponent metrics like any other played game.

When a player concedes, a judge should come to the table. Not to interrogate anyone, since a concession is a legitimate choice and most of them are exactly what they look like. But a concession can also mean a rules problem nobody could resolve, or a player who's had enough of how a game is going, and either of those needs attention rather than a scoreline.

Conceding repeatedly to shape someone else's standings is not a legitimate choice, and is a conduct matter.

ROUND LENGTH

A round is 2 hours 30 minutes, and that includes the draft.

The clock starts when you call the round and ends 2 hours 30 minutes later, whatever stage the game has reached.

Allow roughly 15 minutes for the draft. Time a table saves drafting becomes playing time, which is intentional.

If you're running an event for mostly new players, consider adding 15 minutes to round one only, and say so in advance. Games that run long in round one tend to finish comfortably by round three.

The Last Fifteen Minutes

Don't start a new Battle Round inside the last 15 minutes of the round. Finish the one you're in and score what's on the table.

When Time Is Called

Dice go down. There's no final roll, no last activation, no finishing the sequence you'd started. The game state is whatever it is at the moment time is called, and that's what gets scored.

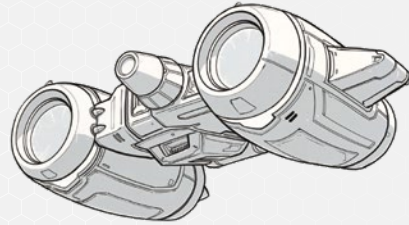
Three things need saying precisely, because they decide games:

- **An interrupted activation isn't resolved.** Roll it back to the state before it began
- **An attack with hit rolls already made is finished.** The defender takes their Armour or Evade Rolls, damage is applied, and that's where it stops

- **Scoring that happens at the end of a Battle Round only counts for Battle Rounds that were completed.** A Battle Round cut short by time scores nothing for either player

Games That Didn't Get Far Enough

If a table hasn't completed two full Battle Rounds when time is called, a judge should look at the game before it's scored. A result off one Battle Round usually says more about how the two players spent their time than about how the game was going. The judge decides whether the result stands, and may treat the shortfall as a slow play matter.



MILESTONE ANNOUNCEMENTS

Call the milestones out loud. It costs you nothing and it's the single most effective thing you can do to get games finished on time. Times are measured on the round clock, from your call.

ELAPSED	REMAINING	CALL
0:00	2:30	"Round begins, draft now"
0:15	2:15	"Drafts should be complete"
0:45	1:45	"45 minutes gone"
1:15	1:15	"Halfway"
2:00	0:30	"30 minutes remaining"
2:15	0:15	"15 minutes, do not begin a new Battle Round"
2:25	0:05	"5 minutes"

END OF ROUND

At 5 minutes remaining, have your judges circulate and help players bring games to a close.

Where a game can't reach a natural conclusion before time expires, **players submit their scores as they stand.** We'd recommend not granting extensions, since time given to one table is time taken from every other.

SCORING AND STANDINGS

Two numbers come out of every game. **Match Points** say who won. **Tournament Points** say how convincingly. Everything else in this chapter exists to separate players who end the event level on both.

This chapter applies to both engagement scales. The only thing that changes between Standard and Skirmish is where the Victory Point bands sit, since smaller games produce smaller margins. Everything else works identically.

A judge should attend the table whenever a player concedes (see *Conceding a Game*).

Record a result for every table, every round. A game left blank or entered as 0-0 affects more than those two players. It distorts the standings of everyone who faced either of them.

Scoring a Game

RESULT	VP DIFFERENCE, STANDARD	VP DIFFERENCE, SKIRMISH	WINNER	LOSER
Annihilation	10+	8+	3 MP · 5 TP	0 MP · 0 TP
Decisive Victory	7-9	6-7	3 MP · 4 TP	0 MP · 1 TP
Breakthrough	3-6	3-5	3 MP · 3 TP	0 MP · 2 TP
Stalemate	0-2	0-2	1 MP · 2 TP	1 MP · 2 TP

The result is worked out from the difference in Victory Points at the end of the game

Games That Don't End Normally

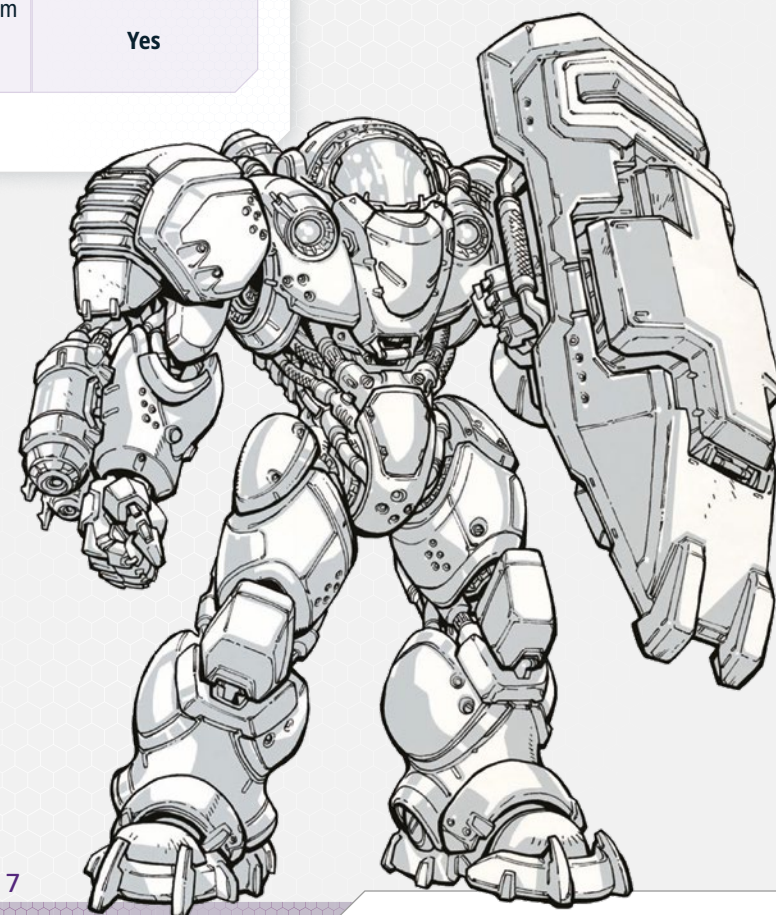
SITUATION	THE PLAYER	THEIR OPPONENT	COUNTS TOWARD SoS / OTP?
Concedes a game	0 MP · 0 TP	3 MP · 5 TP	Yes
Receives a bye	3 MP · 4 TP	—	No
Doesn't appear (no-show or walkover)	0 MP · 0 TP	3 MP · 4 TP	No
Runs out of time	Scored normally from the VP difference on the table	Scored normally from the VP difference on the table	Yes

Standings Order

Placement is decided in this order:

	METRIC	WHAT IT MEASURES
1	Match Points	How much a player won
2	Tournament Points	How convincingly they won
3	Strength of Schedule	How strong their opponents were, by result
4	Opponents' Tournament Points	How strong their opponents were, by margin

Where all four are identical, the placement is shared. Where that happens at the top of the table, we recommend sharing first place between the tied players. It's your event, though, so the call is yours.



The Two Opponent Metrics

Both are averages taken across the opponents a player actually faced, and both use each opponent's final tally after the last round, not where they stood when the game was played.

Strength of Schedule (SoS): the sum of their opponents' final **Match Points**, divided by the number of those opponents.

Opponents' Tournament Points (oTP): the sum of their opponents' final **Tournament Points**, divided by the number of those opponents.

SoS asks whether a player's opponents won. oTP asks how convincingly. Two players can face opponents who finished on identical Match Points but performed very differently within them, and oTP is what tells them apart.

Which Games Count

Every game a player actually played goes into the pool for both metrics, with two exceptions:

- **Byes.** The round doesn't go into the pool
- **Walkovers and no-shows.** Treated as a bye

A conceded game is a played game. It counts toward both metrics like any other result, at its full Annihilation value. A concession that vanished from the pool would be a way of editing someone else's standings after the fact.

Don't enter a zero for a bye or a walkover. The round simply isn't counted, in the numerator or the denominator. Entering a zero quietly penalises every player who received one.

If those exclusions leave a player with nothing in the pool at all, record their **SoS and oTP as 0**.

A player who withdraws mid-event still counts toward their earlier opponents' SoS and oTP, at their final tally.

When to Calculate Them

Work both out once, after the final round, from everyone's final tallies. Anything displayed during the event is indicative only, since a player's SoS moves right up until their earlier opponents have finished their own last games.

Report both to four decimal places, and compare on the unrounded values. At a large event, ties at two decimal places happen more often than you'd think.

THE PRE-GAME SEQUENCE

Before each game, players pick their roster, establish sides and draft the **Mission** and the **Deployment**. Work through the steps in order.

The draft can be resolved with **physical cards** or through the **Tabletop Battles app**. We'd suggest the two players agree which before they start.

Step 1 — Roster Selection

Under **Dual List Format**, both players reveal their chosen roster **at the same time**. They can agree how between themselves; if they can't, each tells a judge privately and the judge announces both at once.

Each player then brings the **draft cards belonging to the roster they've chosen** to the table.

Under Single List Format, skip this step.

Step 2 — Setup

All cards go on the table **face-up**, in two rows:

- **Row 1:** Mission Cards (4 cards)
- **Row 2:** Deployment Cards (4 cards)

Step 3 — Establishing Priority

Priority isn't rolled for. It's earned by spending less:

1. **The player who spent less Vespene Gas takes priority**
2. If Vespene Gas is equal, **the player who spent fewer Minerals takes priority**
3. If both are equal, **both players Roll-Off**

The player who doesn't take priority chooses the perspective, meaning the side of the table the Deployment is oriented from.

The player with priority then makes two choices, in this order:

1. **Colour.** Declare yourself the **Red Player** or the **Blue Player**. This sets your Entry Edge, Zone of Influence and Mission Marker affinity for the whole game.
2. **Draft Control.** Take control of either the **Mission Draft** or the **Deployment Draft**. Your opponent gets the other.

Step 4 — Mission Draft

1. The player **without** Mission Draft control removes any **2 Mission Cards** from the table
2. The player **with** Mission Draft control picks **1 of the 2** that remain. That's the Mission
3. Discard the last card

Step 5 — Deployment Draft

1. The player **without** Deployment Draft control removes any **2 Deployment Cards** from the table
2. The player **with** Deployment Draft control picks **1 of the 2 that remain**. That's the Deployment
3. Discard the last card

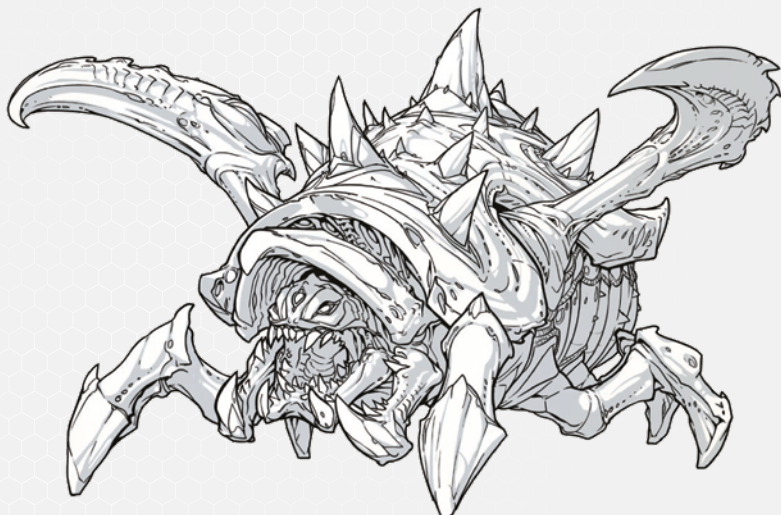
If the sequence overruns. Where the pre-game sequence hasn't concluded 15 minutes into the round, a judge completes the remaining steps at random, following the procedure above. Playing time isn't extended.

JUDGING AND CONDUCT

Rules Disputes

Players are expected to sort out straightforward disagreements themselves. The round clock doesn't stop for rules discussions, which is its own encouragement to be brief.

Where they genuinely can't agree, call a judge straight away rather than playing on under protest.



Penalties

Judges need a scale, and the scale needs to mean the same thing at every table. These four levels cover everything this pack refers to as a “penalty”.

PENALTY	WHO APPLIES IT	WHEN
Caution	Floor Judge	A first, minor slip with no real effect on the game, such as a mismeasure caught immediately or a forgotten step
Warning	Floor Judge	A repeat of something already cautioned, or a slip that did affect the game. Recorded and cumulative
Game Loss	Head Judge	A third Warning in the event, an illegal roster that carried an advantage, or slow play that has already been warned twice
Disqualification	Head Judge, with the Tournament Organiser	Cheating, or a Code of Conduct breach serious enough to end someone's event

Penalties accumulate across the whole event. They don't reset between rounds, and a Warning in round one still counts in round five.

Keep a written record. A sheet at the judges' table or a note in your pairing software is enough. Without one, “a third Warning” is unenforceable, and the second judge to speak to a player has no idea it's the second time.

A Game Loss is scored as an **Annihilation** against the penalised player. A Disqualification ends that player's event: their completed games stand and continue to count toward their opponents' standings, but they take no further part and are not eligible for placings or prizes.

Pace of Play

Every table is expected to keep moving, clock or no clock. Most games that don't finish were simply slow rather than slow-played. But deliberately burning the round while ahead is unsporting conduct, and it's the easiest way to steal a game in a system that scores whatever is on the table when time is called.

Judges don't need to be called to act on this. **If a table is visibly behind the milestone calls, a judge can step in unprompted.**

Where a judge decides a player is taking unreasonable time:

- **First:** a Caution, logged
- **Then:** the judge may impose a time limit per activation for the rest of the game
- **If it continues:** a Warning, and the judge may award the opponent an appropriate remedy, up to a **Game Loss**

This applies whether or not a chess clock is in use. A clock makes pace self-policing (see Chess Clocks); without one, the judge takes that role.

Code of Conduct

Everyone at your event, players, judges, spectators and staff alike, is expected to treat everyone else with respect.

The following are prohibited, and may lead to penalties up to immediate disqualification and removal from the venue:

- Harassment of any kind, including sexual harassment
- Hate speech or slurs
- Intimidation, threats or physical aggression
- Cheating, including misrepresenting rules, dice results, measurements or roster contents
- **Withholding information about your own army.** Give your opponent the clearest possible picture of what your models can do, what they're carrying and what you're able to do in response. If they'd need to ask, tell them first
- Theft or damage to property
- Persistent unsportsmanlike behaviour after being asked to stop

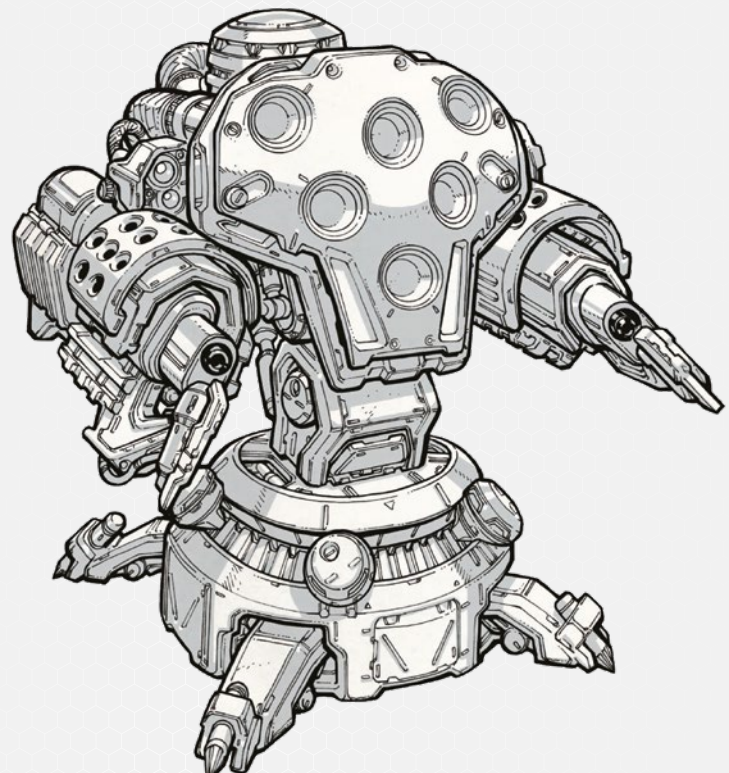
Name a specific point of contact for conduct reports in your event materials, and make sure reports can be made discreetly.

Disqualifications for conduct are recorded and reported to the publisher.

Accessibility

Tell players in your event materials:

- Whether there's step-free access and an accessible toilet
- Whether tables are seated or standing, and whether seating can be provided on request
- Who to contact about accommodations, and by when. A week before the event is a reasonable ask



SIDE EVENTS

There's no top cut in StarCraft: TMG. Every player plays every round, and that's deliberate. A player who's out of contention after round three is still somebody's round four opponent, and their result still feeds four other people's standings.

The risk at your event isn't boredom at the top of the table. **It's the player at the bottom quietly deciding to go home.**

The Problem Side Events Solve

A player sitting at 0–3 has two more games with nothing on the line. Some of them will leave, and a drop costs more than one player's afternoon. Their remaining opponents get a walkover instead of a game, and everyone who already played them has their Strength of Schedule and oTP reshaped by a record that stopped moving.

Side events are how you make staying worth it. They don't replace the rounds a player still has to play. They give them something else to be at the venue for.

Where They Fit

- **The evening between day one and day two.** Your two-day field is already there, already fed, and has nothing scheduled. A Skirmish-scale mini-tournament fills it perfectly
- **Lunch breaks and long gaps,** if your schedule has them
- **After the final round,** while you're calculating standings and setting up the awards. This is the most reliably empty hour of any tournament
- **For players who have already dropped.** Somebody who's genuinely done with the main event should have somewhere to go

What to Run

- **A Skirmish-scale mini-tournament.** Short games, two or three rounds, self-contained
- **Open play tables** for anyone who just wants a relaxed game
- **A learn-to-play table** for spectators, partners and anyone who wandered in off the street
- **A painting or display competition,** which runs itself all weekend and costs you a table

One Rule

A side event must never be a reason to leave the main tournament early. Don't schedule anything that overlaps a round, and don't let a player swap a round-five game for a side event. The point is to keep people in the building and in the tournament.

If a top cut format is announced for larger events, side events alongside it will follow the same principle.

Hobby Awards

These cost you almost nothing and they're consistently what players remember. They also give a player who's out of contention something to still be playing for.

Best Painted. Set out a display table, give every attendee a token, and let them vote. Player-voted awards avoid you having to justify a judgement call, and they get people looking at each other's armies.

Best in Faction. One for Terran, one for Protoss, one for Zerg. Spreads the recognition across the room and gives players who aren't in contention something to aim at.

Best Sportsman. One nomination per player, submitted with their last result.

Running Them Well

- **Announce them with the event,** not on the day. People plan around them
- **Give somebody the job.** A side event nobody owns doesn't happen
- **Keep the entry barrier at zero.** No extra fee, no separate registration if you can avoid it
- **Keep them short.** Anything that can't finish inside its window will eat into the main event

CHESSE CLOCKS

General Etiquette

Playing on a clock isn't the default at every table. **But if even one player wants to play the game on a clock, both players are obliged to do so.** There's no negotiating it.

Players intending to use a clock should bring their own: a physical clock, or a chess clock app installed and tested on their phone before they arrive.

The point of a clock is **time parity**. Both players get the same pool of minutes, and neither loses a game to the other's pace.

Deliberately playing slowly, or stretching out decisions to burn the round, is unsporting conduct and can carry a penalty. Take any dispute to a judge straight away.

Time Allocation and Setup

The round is **2 hours 30 minutes (150 minutes)**, and that covers everything: pairings, reading rosters, the Mission and Deployment draft, deploying units, and the game itself.

Each player manages their own pool. Nobody else is responsible for watching your clock.

When you first start the clock: check how much of the round is actually left, **subtract 5 minutes as a buffer** for judge calls, and split what remains evenly between the two players.

If your opponent isn't at the table, or is dragging out their preparation, you may start the clock on their time. **Tell a judge before you start counting.**

Pausing the Clock

The only reason to stop the clock mid-game is a serious rules dispute that needs a judge. Time is held from the moment the judge is called until they've given their ruling.

Ordinary questions about rules interactions and minor doubts are resolved **on the time of the player asking them.**

Action Economy and Switching

Every tactical decision and declaration a player makes must happen on their own time.

Switch the clock smoothly and often, so it reflects who's actually making a decision right now.

By default, time runs for the player carrying out their activation. **If the opposing player has to make a decision during that activation,** whether that's declaring a reaction, resolving an effect of their own or weighing up an ability, **the clock should be switched to them immediately.**

Short, routine actions taken at a reasonable pace, such as a passive player making Armour Rolls, don't need a switch every time, as long as they aren't causing hold-ups.

Running Out of Time

When a player's clock reaches zero, they lose the ability to take active decisions. They can't play cards or use unique abilities, and for the rest of the game they're restricted as follows:

Movement and Assault Phases (Phases 1 & 2). On their activation, the player must nominate one of their unactivated units, if they have one, and automatically take the **Hold** action with it. That's a pass, even if the unit is in combat. No effects or abilities tied to activation may be used.

Exception, Deploy from Reserves. Instead of Hold, a player out of time may take the **Deploy** action for a unit in Reserves. That unit must finish its move inside its own **Zone of Influence**.

Combat Phase (Phase 3). The player activates units and makes Attack Rolls as part of a Close Combat Attack as normal.

Still permitted at any time. A player out of time keeps the right to make **Armour Rolls** and **Evade Rolls**, to fight in the Combat Phase, and to score **Victory Points**.

All of this must be done promptly. An opponent may choose to let a player out of time use the opponent's own remaining minutes, but that's a favour, given at their own risk, and it can be withdrawn at any moment.

These procedures exist to stop the extreme cases. In an ordinary, well-paced game there's no need to enforce them.

For more information about how to use a chess clock effectively, check out this article on Tabletop Battles: <https://www.tabletopbattles.com/that-time-again-how-to-use-a-clock>

OPTIONAL: SOFTWARE

Pairings and Standings

We recommend running your event on Best Coast Pairings.

Most competitive miniatures players already have an account, which saves you explaining a new tool to a room on a Saturday morning.

Tell players which platform you're using at registration, and publish full pairings and final standings afterwards.

Whatever platform you choose, **check it handles SoS and oTP the way these rules define them:**

- Both are **means, not sums**
- Both use each opponent's **final** tally
- Byes, walkovers and no-shows are **left out of the pool**, not entered as zeros. Conceded games stay in

That last one is the easiest to get silently wrong, and it quietly penalises every player who received a bye.

Draft and Score Tracking

We recommend the Tabletop Battles app for the pre-game sequence and for tracking scores during play.

It's encouraged rather than required. Where it's used for the draft, both players need to be able to see the card pool and each selection; where it's used for scoring, both need to be able to see the running score at any point.

FEEDBACK

If something didn't survive contact with a real event, whether that's round timings, the clock protocol or the tiebreakers, please tell us.

